

Board Engagement Summary:
Slido Results for the Virtual Listening Session
April 20, 2026

On April 20th, the Board of Education held a virtual engagement session for the public. Slido questions received between 69-169 responses. Winterhaven K-8, Odyssey K-8, Creston Elementary, and Peninsula Elementary were the most highly represented schools; 86% of respondents were connected to K-5 schools. 5% of participants identified as African American/Black, 2% as American Indian/Alaska Native, 5% identified as Asian, 5% identified as Latine, 1% as Middle Eastern/North African, 76% identified as white, and 9% identified as multiracial. Nearly half of respondents (45%) reported that their student was identified as Gifted and Talented, and 70% of families indicated that they had not experienced a school transition in the last five years.

When asked what has helped students feel connected as they move between schools, families emphasized the importance of keeping peer cohorts together, maintaining stable teaching staff, and ensuring high levels of transparency regarding classroom changes. This group shared that a sense of security is built through walkable neighborhood connections, robust welcoming programs, and long-term relationships with teachers.

Families sometimes opted to change schools in order to find a specialized academic fit, such as TAG-focused instruction at ACCESS or STEM programming at Winterhaven, or in response to boredom or unaddressed learning needs in their assigned schools. Others move to escape safety concerns, including unaddressed classroom violence. Some reported shifting from private Montessori or immersion programs to reclaim the sense of community found in neighborhood-based public schools. Finally, the lack of consistent resources drove several families to seek the stability and continuity of K-8 models or private alternatives.

Due to time constraints, participants in this session were not asked to rank the PPS student assignment policy or factors that contribute to a positive school environment. These data were collected in the feedback form, which will be analyzed at a later date.